

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

A trusted neighbourhood support plan

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Build a small support network with people you already trust: agree check-ins, practical tasks and boundaries before a crisis. Share verified information and safe assistance without advertising stockpiles or exposing vulnerable people's locations. Do not organise untrained rescues or assume outside supplies will arrive.

Do now.

- ☐ **Agree who participates**
01 Ask consent and include people who may need help with movement, medication or communication. Do not publish a public list of vulnerable households.
- ☐ **Assign realistic tasks**
02 Choose check-in, charging, water transport or childcare tasks people can perform safely. Do not assign dangerous repairs, rescues or conflict-zone travel.
- ☐ **Choose backups**
03 Have another contact and a written way to reconnect if phones fail. Make sure no essential task depends on one person being present.
- ☐ **Set boundaries**
04 Agree what can be shared, how decisions are made and what people cannot safely offer. Do not promise supplies or transport you do not have.
- ☐ **Review together**
05 Practise a short check-in and update the plan after household needs change. Keep information current and private.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Start with a few trusted people and one useful task. If no network exists, use your household plan and independently verify any offer before relying on it.

Watch for.

Mutual aid should never require handing over identity documents, leaving children with strangers or entering a dangerous building.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group. Make decisions around the least mobile person, not the fastest; avoid splitting the family without a clear, safe way to reconnect. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: agree who participates. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. Mutual aid should never require handing over identity documents, leaving children with strangers or entering a dangerous building.

Keep essentials within reach.

For a trusted neighbourhood support plan, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Start with a few trusted people and one useful task. If no network exists, use your household plan and independently verify any offer before relying on it. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Use the network to coordinate verified information and reduce duplicated trips. Independent humanitarian assistance can complement it when available, but should not be its only foundation.

First decision: Agree who participates

Ask consent and include people who may need help with movement, medication or communication. Do not publish a public list of vulnerable households. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Start with a few trusted people and one useful task. If no network exists, use your household plan and independently verify any offer before relying on it. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

Mutual aid should never require handing over identity documents, leaving children with strangers or entering a dangerous building. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Build a small support network with people you already trust: agree check-ins, practical tasks and boundaries before a crisis. Share verified information and safe assistance without advertising stockpiles or exposing vulnerable people's locations. Do not organise untrained rescues or assume outside supplies will arrive. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For a trusted neighbourhood support plan, keep the specific hazard in view: Mutual aid should never require handing over identity documents, leaving children with strangers or entering a dangerous building.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Review together. Practise a short check-in and update the plan after household needs change. Keep information current and private. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

Household emergency plan · official guidance

<https://www.ready.gov/plan>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/community-support/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.